

Sole Source (Including Brand Name) Justification - Simplified Procedures for Certain Commercial Items

NOTE: If a Justification was approved for the preceding acquisition, a copy of the approved Justification for the predecessor action must be included in the staff package for approval of the instant Justification. This applies to Justification staff packages that are submitted for review and approval at a level above the contracting officer. The predecessor Justification will be used as a reference document by the approving official.

Is this a new or amended J&A Document? ☒ New ☐ Amended (Prior to Award Only!)

Is this a Bridge Action as defined in the [AF Bridge Action Reduction Plan](#)? ☐ Yes ☒ No

Funding level for this acquisition:

Contracting Activity: AFMC/PZIMA

Purchase Request / Local ID Number: FA8125-26-Q-0043

Program / Project (and PE, if applicable): Masking Tape Blanket Purchase Agreement

Program Type (PEO or Other Contracting): Other Contracting, Maintenance Operational

Authority: ☒ RFO FAR Part 12.201-1 Simplified Procedures (41 U.S.C. 1901- and 1903)

☐ AFFARS 5313.501 - 10 U.S.C. 2304a, Special Emergency Procurement Authority (41 U.S.C. 1903)

Estimated Contract Cost (including options):

Justification Type: ☐ Class ☒ Individual

COORDINATION ([DAF Part 6](#))

[Sign and Save Procedure](#)

** The text in the signature blocks below is editable, including the title.

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I. Contracting Activity.

Department: Air Force Materiel Command (AFMC)

Officer Symbol: AFSC/PZIMA

Address: 3001 Staff Drive 2S75 Tinker AFB, OK 73145

Program: 76 Aircraft Maintenance Group (AMXG) Masking tape Blanket Purchase Agreement (BPA).

II. Nature and/or description of the action being processed.

The 76 AMXG is requesting a five (5) year BPA to purchase 3M 401+ masking tape in accordance with (IAW) the item description. The purpose of this Brand Name Justification (BNJ) is to specify the use of 3M 401+ to support 569 Maintenance Support Group (AMXS) with corrosion control/aircraft paint process for the [REDACTED], [REDACTED] aircraft.

III. Description of supplies/services required to meet agency needs.

The 76 AMXG/569 AMXS is requesting a 5-year BPA for 3M 401+ masking tape.

The requested equipment description/specifications are outlined below:

- a. Item one - Masking Tape 24mm (1 inch) x 55m (60 yards)
- b. Item two - Masking Tape 48mm (2 inch) x 55m (60 yards)
- c. Item three - Masking Tape 76mm (3 inch) x 55m (60 yards)
- d. Item four - Masking Tape 12mm (1/2 inch) x 55m (60 yards)

All tapes listed in item two shall adhere to the following requirements:

- a. Tape shall adhere to SAE AMS-T-21595 (formerly MIL-T-21595). Types 1,2
- b. Tape shall be single-sided and have a natural/synthetic rubber adhesive blend
- c. Tape backing shall be a crepe paper.
- d. Tape shall have an Adhesive strength of 35oz/in- 50oz/in per ASTM D3330.
- e. Tape shall have a minimum tensile strength of 24lb/in per ASTM D3759.
- f. Tape shall have a minimum elongation of 14% per ASTM D3759.
- g. Tape shall be capable of high temperature use and be rated for a minimum surface temperature of 249F for 30 minutes
- h. Tape color shall be green.

Tape shall be delivered with a minimum of six (6) months of shelf life remaining.

This total estimated price listed below was developed based off Rough Order of Magnitude (ROM)s received from small businesses during the Market Research phase by OC-ALC/OB as well as Internet searches of the commercial items and a 3% annual inflation per year added to develop the overall value of a five-year period:

[REDACTED]

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[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

The BPA will be established at \$4.5M to account for unforeseen purchases, escalation, and potential increased workflow.

Projected funding appropriation is Working Capital Funds.

IV. Statutory authority permitting other than full and open competition.

RFO FAR 12.201-1, Simplified Procedures (41 U.S.C. 1901).

V. Demonstration that the contractor's unique qualifications or nature of the acquisition requires the use of the authority cited above (applicability of authority).

The 569th maintenance and repair activities necessitate a masking tape that provides exceptional performance characteristics. Extensive evaluation and practical application have demonstrably established that only 3M 401+ masking tape meets these specific requirements that are crucial to the processes at Tinker Air Force Base (TAFB). The use of alternative masking tapes has resulted in increased labor costs, rework, potential for [REDACTED] and decreased efficiency, as detailed below:

- **Superior De-masking Performance and Cost Avoidance:** 3M 401+ masking tape is significantly more resistant to tearing and splintering during both sealant and stenciling de-masking processes. Compared to inferior tapes like IPG tape and 3M 232 tape, this leads to a considerable reduction in the time required for tape removal and minimizes the risk of tape fragments remaining on the aircraft, which can become [REDACTED] or cause defects in the paint job. Time studies show that 3M 401+ tape saves approximately 6.6 man-hours per aircraft during sealant de-masking alone, translating to an annual cost avoidance of [REDACTED] across the 190 aircraft scheduled for work in FY25. In stenciling de-masking, using 3M 401+ will save up to [REDACTED] in rework costs per year.
- **Enhanced Visibility and Defect Reduction:** The distinct green color of 3M 401+ masking tape provides significantly improved visibility during inspections. This increased visibility assists in identifying areas where tape was improperly applied or left on the aircraft. The increased visibility results in time savings of [REDACTED] per year. The use of the tape has been directly linked to a reduction in write-ups related to improper or missing masking and, most importantly, has eliminated the risk of [REDACTED] resulting from masking tape left on the aircraft. The elimination of these writeups is expected to prevent approximately four (4) [REDACTED] defects per year.
- **Reduced Stencil Bleed-Through and Rework:** The flexibility and adhesion of 3M 401+ tape effectively prevent paint bleed-through during stenciling. This minimizes the need for rework, which can be time-consuming and resource-intensive, often requiring sanding, repainting, and re-stenciling. The use of 3M 401+ is expected to save [REDACTED] in rework related to stencil bleed-

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through defects each year.

- Improved Water Resistance and Process Efficiency: Compared to alternatives, 3M 401+ tape demonstrates superior water resistance. This is critical during washing processes, as weaker tapes tend to tear and splinter when wet, making removal more difficult and requiring the use of solvents to remove adhesive residue. Using 3M 401+ is expected to result in [REDACTED] in cost avoidance per year.
- Reliable Performance in Enclosure Building: The conformability, flexibility, and adhesion of 3M 401+ tape are essential for constructing plastic sheeting enclosures for blasting and painting activities. These tents must withstand pressure and de-pressurization cycles. The 401+ tape minimizes seam failure, preventing media spills [REDACTED], cleaning up the spill, and rebuilding the enclosure. Using 3M 401+ is expected to result in [REDACTED] in cost avoidance per year.

Based on the aforementioned information, 3M 401+ masking tape is the only brand that demonstrates the unique characteristics of this specific brand are essential to meeting the agency's requirements for efficient and safe aircraft maintenance. The documented cost savings and [REDACTED] avoidance, coupled with the performance enhancements provided by 3M 401+ masking tape. The use of any other masking tape presents an [REDACTED] increased costs, [REDACTED], rework, and [REDACTED]. Therefore, limiting competition to 3M 401+ is the only practical approach to ensure the successful and cost-effective execution of the 569th corrosion control program. The demonstrated [REDACTED] cost avoidance associated with 3M 401+ masking tape per year supports this conclusion.

VI. Description of efforts made to ensure that offers are solicited from as many potential sources as practicable.

Market research was performed reviewing Dynamic Small Business Search (DSBS) and System for Award Management (SAM) databases using North American Industry Classification System (NAICS) Code (325520) looking for companies that could provide 3M 401+ Masking Tape under Federal Supply Code (FSC 8040). A review of small businesses to include 8(a), HUBZone, Service-Disabled Veteran Owned Business, and Women Owned Small Business was conducted in search of a company that could provide 3M 401+ Masking Tape. A sources sought was conducted on 24 September 2025 which yielding three (3) Rough Order of Magnitude (ROM)s. In addition, the Government received 6 (six) additional interested vendors that can supply the tape to the Government. The vendors are as follows:

1. Johnston Industrial (Provided ROM)

Cage Code 0FL68

Women-Owned Small Business

2. Scientific Sales (Provided ROM)

Cage Code 09NX5

Women-Owned Small Business

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3. Incredible Supply LLC (Provided ROM)

Cage Code 5ARU4

Small Business

4. Able Industrial Products

Cage Code 2S188

Women-Owned Small Business

5. ABT Trading Group, LLC

Cage Code 8JHA3

Small Disadvantaged Business

6. ANA Sourcing LLC

Cage Code 0WZP3

Women-Owned Small Business

7. BHPE LLC

Cage Code 9SWS7

Service Disabled Veteran-Owned Small Business

8. Cail Tool and Machinery, INC

Cage Code 0WCV0

Women Owned Small Business

9. Ferro Solutions LLC

Cage Code 104G1

Service Disabled Veteran-Owned Small Business

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VII. Determination by the Contracting Officer that the anticipated cost to the Government will be fair and reasonable.

The contracting officer anticipates this requirement will be a competitive, small business set aside; therefore, adequate price competition IAW RFO 15.403-1(1) will be applicable. However, the Contracting Officer may use price analysis IAW RFO FAR 15.404-1 to determine the contract price to be fair and reasonable. Since this is a commercial item requirement as defined by RFO FAR Part 2, the Government may request other than certified cost or pricing data if necessary, to determine the price to be fair and reasonable.

VIII. Description of the market research conducted and the results, or a statement of the reasons market research was not conducted.

Market research was performed reviewing Dynamic Small Business Search (DSBS) and System for Award Management (SAM) databases using North American Industry Classification System (NAICS) Code (325520) looking for companies that could provide 3M 401+ Masking Tape under Federal Supply Code (FSC 8040). A review of small businesses to include 8(a), HUBZone, Service-Disabled Veteran Owned Business, and Women Owned Small Business was conducted in search of a company that could provide 3M 401+ Masking Tape. A sources sought was conducted on 24 September 2025 which yielding three (3) Rough Order of Magnitude (ROM)s. In addition, the Government received 6 (six) additional interested vendors that can supply the tape to the Government.

IX. Any other facts supporting the use of Other Than Full and Open Competition.

No other information.

X. List of any sources that expressed, in writing, an interest in the acquisition.

The following sources either provided ROMs to the Government and/or expressed interest during the market research phase:

1. Johnston Industrial (Provided ROM)

Cage Code OFL68

Women-Owned Small Business

2. Scientific Sales (Provided ROM)

Cage Code 09NX5

Women-Owned Small Business

3. Incredible Supply LLC (Provided ROM)

Cage Code 5ARU4

Small Business

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4. Able Industrial Products

Cage Code 2S188

Women-Owned Small Business

5. ABT Trading Group, LLC

Cage Code 8JHA3

Small Disadvantaged Business

6. ANA Sourcing LLC

Cage Code 0WZP3

Women-Owned Small Business

7. BHPE LLC

Cage Code 9SWS7

Service Disabled Veteran-Owned Small Business

8. Cail Tool and Machinery, INC

Cage Code 0WCV0

Women Owned Small Business

9. Ferro Solutions LLC

Cage Code 104G1

Service Disabled Veteran-Owned Small Business

XI. A statement of the actions, if any, the agency may take to remove or overcome any barriers to competition before making subsequent acquisitions for the supplies or services required.

In an effort to identify and remove barriers to competition, the Government will continue to monitor the marketplace for source development and continue discussions with the OEM regarding additional approved sources.

XII. Certification by the Contracting Officer.

As evidenced by my signature above, I have determined this document to be both accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.

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XIII. Certification by the technical/requirements personnel.

As evidenced by my signature above, I certify that any supporting data contained herein, which is my (our) responsibility, is both accurate and complete.

☒ Remove the Guidance pages below.